

Here's the full family curation for **death / die / dying / dead**, anchored to the passage phrase **"between life and death."** I'm treating this as one lexical family and doing the full sweep across **noun, verb, adjective, participial forms, figurative extensions, fixed expressions, and common compounds**. The full **MCQ-ready master list** is included.

DEATH / DIE / DYING / DEAD

1. Passage anchor

> "She then finds herself in a mysterious library between life and **death**..."

Passage meaning

death = the end of a living being's life

死亡 ; 生命終結

Here, **life and death** are used in their literal biological sense.

Practice

1. The novel imagines a place between life and **death**.

小說想像了一個介乎生與**死**之間的地方。

2. Different cultures have different beliefs about **death**.

不同文化對**死亡**有不同看法。

Core family map

The family divides primarily like this:

* **die** — verb: stop being alive

* **death** — noun: the end of life

* **dead** — adjective: no longer alive

* **dying** — adjective/participle: approaching death; gradually disappearing

* **deadly** — causing death / extremely dangerous

* **deathly** — resembling death; extremely pale, still, quiet, etc.

DIE

2. die — stop being alive

= cease to live

****死；死亡****

Examples

1. The animal ****died**** during the night.

那隻動物在夜間****死了****。

2. He ****died**** at the age of ninety.

他九十歲時****去世****。

This is the central verb sense.

3. die of something

= die because of an illness, condition, hunger, etc.

****死於.....****

Examples

1. Many people once ****died of**** infectious diseases.

過去很多人曾****死於****傳染病。

2. The plants ****died of**** lack of water.

植物因缺水而****枯死****。

4. die from something

= die because of an external cause, injury, accident, etc.

****因.....而死****

Examples

1. He ****died from**** his injuries.

他因傷勢而****死亡****。

2. Fish can ****die from**** polluted water.

魚可能因受污染的水而****死亡****。

In modern use, ****die of**** and ****die from**** overlap considerably.

Figurative disappearance / ending

5. die — cease to exist or disappear

= gradually end, disappear, or stop existing

****消失；消亡；滅絕****

Examples

1. Some traditions are slowly ****dying****.

有些傳統正逐漸****消失****。

2. The old custom eventually ****died****.

那個舊習俗最終****消亡了****。

Major figurative extension.

6. die out

= disappear completely, especially a species, tradition, skill, custom, etc.

****滅絕；消失；失傳****

Examples

1. Many species are at risk of ****dying out****.

很多物種面臨****滅絕****風險。

2. The tradition nearly ****died out****.

那項傳統差點****失傳****。

Very high-value phrasal verb.

7. die away

= gradually become weaker and disappear, especially sound, light, wind, etc.

****逐漸減弱並消失****

Examples

1. The music slowly ****died away****.

音樂聲慢慢****減弱直至消失****。

2. The laughter ****died away****.

笑聲逐漸****消失****。

8. die down

= become gradually less strong, active, or intense

****逐漸平息；減弱****

Examples

1. The wind finally ****died down****.

風勢終於****減弱了****。

2. The excitement began to ****die down****.

興奮的氣氛開始****平息****。

9. die off

= die one after another until many or most are gone

****相繼死亡；大量死亡****

Examples

1. The plants began to ****die off**** in the heat.

植物在高溫中開始****大量枯死****。

2. Several older trees ****died off****.

幾棵老樹相繼****枯死****。

Stop functioning

10. die — machine/device stops working

Informal:

= stop operating or lose power

****停止運作；沒電；死機****

Examples

1. My phone ****died**** halfway through the day.

我的手機一天過了一半就****沒電了****。

2. The engine suddenly ****died****.

引擎突然****熄火 / 停止運作****。

Very common modern extension.

11. battery dies

= battery loses all usable charge

****電池沒電****

Examples

1. My battery ****died**** during the call.

通話期間我的電池****沒電了****。

2. The camera ****died**** because the battery was empty.

相機因電池耗盡而****關機了****。

Strong desire / emotion

12. be dying to do something

= want very much to do something

****非常想 ; 迫不及待想****

Examples

1. I'm ****dying to read**** the next chapter.

我****非常想讀****下一章。

2. She is ****dying to know**** what happened.

她****迫不及待想知道****發生了甚麼。

Very common idiomatic use.

13. be dying for something

= want or need something very badly

****非常想要；極需要****

Examples

1. I'm ****dying for a coffee****.

我****超想喝杯咖啡****。

2. After the walk, we were ****dying for some water****.

走完那段路後，我們****非常想喝水****。

Informal; usually exaggeration, not literal death.

Embarrassment / laughter

14. die of embarrassment / laughter

Informal hyperbole:

= feel extremely embarrassed / laugh very strongly

****尷尬死了；笑死了****

Examples

1. I nearly ****died of embarrassment****.

我簡直****尷尬死了****。

2. We were ****dying with laughter****.

我們都****笑翻了****。

This is figurative exaggeration.

DEATH

15. death — end of life

= permanent end of the life of a person, animal, or organism

****死亡****

Examples

1. His ****death**** shocked the community.

他的**去世**震驚了社區。

2. The disease can cause **death**.

這種疾病可能導致**死亡**。

This is the exact passage branch.

16. a death

= individual instance of someone dying

一宗死亡；一人死亡

Examples

1. The accident resulted in one **death**.

事故造成一人**死亡**。

2. The hospital reported no further **deaths**.

醫院沒有再報告新的**死亡個案**。

Figurative ending / destruction

17. death — end or destruction of something

= complete ending, disappearance, or destruction of an activity, system, tradition, etc.

終結；消亡

Examples

1. Some feared the **death of print**.

有些人擔心紙本出版的**消亡**。

2. The decision could mean the **death of the project**.

這個決定可能意味著專案的**終結**。

18. death of a tradition / industry / idea

= complete or near-complete ending of something abstract

傳統 / 產業 / 理念的消亡

Examples

1. The change did not lead to the **death of the industry**.
這個改變並沒有導致該產業的**消亡**。
2. People predicted the **death of handwriting**.
人們曾預言手寫會**消失**。

Personified Death

19. Death — personification

Capitalized:

= personified force or figure representing death

死神；死亡的擬人化形象

Examples

1. **Death** appears as a character in many stories.
死神在很多故事中都會以角色出現。
2. Medieval art often personified **Death**.
中世紀藝術常把**死亡擬人化**。

Deadliness / cause of death

20. cause of death

= medical or factual reason someone died

死因

Examples

1. The report identified the **cause of death**.
報告確認了**死因**。
2. The exact **cause of death** remained unclear.
確切**死因**仍不清楚。

21. death toll

= number of people killed in an event, disaster, conflict, etc.

****死亡人數；死亡數字****

Examples

1. The ****death toll**** continued to rise.

****死亡人數****持續上升。

2. Officials revised the ****death toll****.

官員修訂了****死亡數字****。

Legal / punishment

22. death penalty

= legal punishment of execution

****死刑****

Examples

1. The country abolished the ****death penalty****.

該國廢除了****死刑****。

2. The debate focused on the ****death penalty****.

辯論集中在****死刑****問題上。

23. death sentence

A. literal legal sentence

****死刑判決****

1. He received a ****death sentence****.

他被判****死刑****。

B. figurative

= something likely to cause the end or destruction of something

****等同宣判死刑；致命打擊****

2. Losing that contract could be a **death sentence** for the company.

失去那份合約對公司來說可能等同**致命打擊**。

24. death row

= prison area where prisoners sentenced to death are held

死囚牢房；死囚區

Examples

1. He spent years on **death row**.

他在**死囚區**待了多年。

2. The documentary examines life on **death row**.

紀錄片探討**死囚區**中的生活。

DEAD

25. dead — no longer alive

= no longer living

死的；已死亡的

Examples

1. The bird was **dead**.

那隻鳥已經**死了**。

2. The tree is completely **dead**.

那棵樹已經完全**枯死**。

Central adjective sense.

26. dead — no longer functioning

= no longer operating or working

壞掉的；沒電的；失效的

Examples

1. My phone is ****dead****.

我的手機****沒電了****。

2. The engine is ****dead****.

引擎已經****完全停止運作****。

27. dead battery

= battery with no usable charge

****沒電的電池****

Examples

1. The car would not start because of a ****dead battery****.

車因為****電池沒電****而無法啟動。

2. I replaced the ****dead battery****.

我換掉了****沒電的電池****。

No activity / very quiet

28. dead — completely inactive or empty

= lacking activity, movement, business, excitement, etc.

****冷清的；死氣沉沉的；毫無活動的****

Examples

1. The town centre was ****dead**** after midnight.

午夜後市中心非常****冷清****。

2. Business was ****dead**** that afternoon.

那天下午生意****很淡****。

29. dead silence

= complete silence

****一片死寂；完全安靜****

Examples

1. The room fell into ****dead silence****.

房間陷入****一片死寂****。

2. There was ****dead silence**** after the announcement.

公布消息後全場****鴉雀無聲****。

Completely / exactly

30. dead — completely

Informal intensifier:

= completely; absolutely

****完全地；徹底地****

Examples

1. I was ****dead tired****.

我****累透了****。

2. The road was ****dead straight****.

那條路****筆直得不得了****。

31. dead right / dead wrong

= completely correct / completely incorrect

****完全正確 / 完全錯誤****

Examples

1. You were ****dead right****.

你****完全說對了****。

2. My first guess was ****dead wrong****.

我最初的猜測****完全錯了****。

32. dead centre / dead ahead

= exactly in the centre / exactly straight ahead

****正中央 / 正前方****

Examples

1. The arrow hit ****dead centre****.
箭射中****正中央****。
2. The island was ****dead ahead****.
島就在****正前方****。

No sensation / numb

33. dead — numb or without feeling

= temporarily lacking sensation

****麻木的；沒有知覺的****

Examples

1. My leg went ****dead**** after I sat on it too long.
我壓著腿坐太久，腿都****麻了****。
2. His fingers felt ****dead**** in the cold.
他的手指冷得****失去知覺****。

Communication / technology

34. dead line / connection

= line or connection that is no longer working

****失效線路；沒有訊號的連線****

Examples

1. The phone line went ****dead****.
電話線突然****斷了 / 沒訊號了****。
2. The connection was completely ****dead****.
連線完全****失效了****。

Dead language / dead system

35. dead language

= language no longer spoken as a native everyday language

****死語；已無母語使用者的語言****

Examples

1. Latin is often described as a ****dead language****.

拉丁語常被稱為****死語****。

2. A ****dead language**** may still be studied academically.

****死語****仍可能在學術上被研究。

36. dead technology / format

= no longer actively used or supported

****已淘汰的；停止使用的****

Examples

1. The format is practically ****dead****.

那種格式實際上已經****淘汰****。

2. The technology is not quite ****dead**** yet.

那項技術還沒有完全****退出歷史舞台****。

Emotional / metaphorical state

37. dead inside

Informal:

= emotionally numb, empty, or unable to feel

****內心麻木；心如死灰****

Examples

1. He joked that he felt ****dead inside**** after the exhausting week.

他開玩笑說累了一星期後自己已經****心如死灰****。

2. The character describes herself as ****dead inside****.

那個角色形容自己****內心麻木****。

Often hyperbolic.

DYING

38. dying — approaching death

= close to death

****垂死的；瀕死的****

Examples

1. The doctor stayed beside the ****dying patient****.

醫生留在那名****垂死病人****身旁。

2. They cared for a ****dying animal****.

他們照顧一隻****瀕死的動物****。

39. dying — disappearing / becoming extinct

= gradually ceasing to exist, be used, or be practiced

****逐漸消失的；瀕臨消亡的****

Examples

1. It is a ****dying tradition****.

這是一項****逐漸消失的傳統****。

2. Some describe the craft as a ****dying art****.

有些人把這門手藝形容為****日漸式微的技藝****。

40. dying industry / town

= industry/place in serious decline

****日漸衰退的產業 / 城鎮****

Examples

1. The region depended on a **dying industry**.

該地區依賴一個**日漸衰退的產業**。

2. Shops were closing in the **dying town**.

那個**日漸沒落的城鎮**有很多商店倒閉。

Deathbed

41. deathbed

= bed on which someone is dying; also the final period before death

臨終病床；臨終時

Examples

1. He made the request on his **deathbed**.

他在**臨終時**提出這個要求。

2. It was described as a **deathbed confession**.

那被形容為**臨終告白**。

DEADLY

42. deadly — capable of causing death

= likely or able to kill

致命的

Examples

1. The snake's venom can be **deadly**.

那條蛇的毒液可能是**致命的**。

2. The disease can become **deadly**.

這種疾病可能變得**致命**。

43. deadly — extremely dangerous

= very dangerous, even if not literally causing death in every case

極危險的；致命性的

Examples

1. The combination can be **deadly**.
這種組合可能**極度危險**。
2. Drivers must avoid **deadly mistakes**.
駕駛者必須避免可能造成嚴重後果的**致命錯誤**。

44. deadly — extremely effective / accurate

= extremely effective, precise, or dangerous in performance
極具殺傷力的；非常準確有效的

Examples

1. The striker is **deadly** in front of goal.
那名前鋒在球門前**極具殺傷力**。
2. She has **deadly accuracy**.
她的準確度**高得驚人**。

Common sports/metaphorical extension.

DEATHLY

45. deathly — like death

= extremely pale, still, quiet, cold, etc., in a way associated with death
死一般的；慘白的；死寂的

Examples

1. His face turned **deathly pale**.
他的臉變得**慘白**。
2. A **deathly silence** filled the room.
房間裡一片**死寂**。

Distinct from **deadly**.

DEADEN

46. deaden

= reduce or remove sensation, sound, pain, emotion, etc.

****使麻木；減弱；消除****

Examples

1. The material helps ****deaden sound****.

這種材料有助於****減弱聲音****。

2. The medicine ****deadened the pain****.

藥物****減輕 / 麻痺了疼痛感****。

Useful family extension.

DEADLOCK

47. deadlock

= situation in which neither side can make progress or reach agreement

****僵局；僵持****

Examples

1. Negotiations ended in ****deadlock****.

談判陷入****僵局****。

2. The two sides are still ****deadlocked****.

雙方仍處於****僵持狀態****。

Lexicalized compound.

DEADLINE

48. deadline

= latest time by which something must be completed

****截止日期****

Examples

1. The application **deadline** is Friday.
申請**截止日期**是星期五。

2. We need to meet the **deadline**.
我們需要趕上**截止日期**。

Lexicalized family member; modern meaning is no longer transparently about literal death.

DEAD END

49. dead end — literal

= road or passage with no exit

死路；**死巷**

Examples

1. The street ends in a **dead end**.
這條街最後是一條**死路**。

2. We accidentally drove into a **dead end**.
我們不小心駛進了一條**死巷**。

50. dead end — figurative

= situation, idea, career path, investigation, etc. that offers no progress

死胡同；沒有出路的情況

Examples

1. The investigation reached a **dead end**.
調查走進了**死胡同**。

2. He felt trapped in a **dead-end job**.
他覺得自己困在一份**沒有前途的工作**裡。

High-value expressions

51. life and death

= involving actual survival/death or something of extreme importance

生死；攸關生死

Examples

1. Doctors sometimes make **life-and-death decisions**.

醫生有時需要作出**生死攸關的決定**。

2. In the passage, the library exists between **life and death**.

在文章中，圖書館存在於**生與死之間**。

52. matter of life and death

= extremely serious matter, literally or figuratively

生死攸關的事情；極其重要的事

Examples

1. In an emergency, timing can be a **matter of life and death**.

在緊急情況下，時間可能**攸關生死**。

2. He spoke as if the decision were a **matter of life and death**.

他說得好像那個決定是件**生死大事**。

53. scare someone to death

= frighten someone extremely badly

把某人嚇死；嚇壞某人

Examples

1. You **scared me to death**!

你**嚇死我了**！

2. That sudden noise nearly **scared her to death**.

那突如其來的聲音差點**嚇壞她**。

Usually hyperbole.

54. bore someone to death

= make someone extremely bored

****把某人悶死；令某人無聊透頂****

Examples

1. The lecture ****bored me to death****.
那場講座讓我****悶死了****。
2. He joked that the meeting would ****bore everyone to death****.
他開玩笑說那場會議會讓大家****無聊死****。

55. work someone to death

= make someone work excessively hard

****把某人操勞至極；讓某人累死****

Examples

1. They are ****working him to death****.
他們簡直把他****操得累死了****。
2. Don't ****work yourself to death****.
不要把自己****累垮****。

Usually figurative.

56. sick to death of something

= extremely tired of or annoyed by something

****厭煩透了；受夠了****

Examples

1. I'm ****sick to death of**** hearing that excuse.
我****受夠了****那個藉口。
2. She was ****sick to death of**** the constant noise.
她對持續的噪音****厭煩透了****。

57. at death's door

= extremely ill and close to death; sometimes exaggerated

病危；命在旦夕

Examples

1. He looked as though he was **at death's door**.
他看起來像是**病危了**。
2. She joked that she felt **at death's door** with the flu.
她開玩笑說自己感冒得像是**快不行了**。

58. to the death

= until one side/person dies; figuratively, with extreme determination

至死；拼到底

Examples

1. In the story, they fought **to the death**.
故事中他們**戰至一方死亡**。
2. The rivals seemed ready to argue **to the death**.
兩個對手似乎準備**爭到底**。

59. drop dead

A. suddenly die

突然死亡

1. The character simply **dropped dead**.
那個角色突然**倒地身亡**。

B. rude command

= go away / expression of strong hostility

滾開；去死吧

Very rude.

2. He angrily told the man to ****drop dead****.

他憤怒地叫那個人****滾開 / 去死****。

60. dead and buried

A. literally dead and buried

****已死並下葬****

B. figuratively completely finished

****徹底結束；早已過去****

Examples

1. That idea is ****dead and buried****.

那個想法已經****徹底被淘汰了****。

2. He thought the controversy was ****dead and buried****.

他以為那場爭議已經****完全告一段落****。

Key contrasts

61. die vs dead

****die****

= verb

****死；死亡****

> He ****died**** yesterday.

> 他昨天****去世了****。

****dead****

= adjective

****死的；已死亡的****

> He is ****dead****.

> 他已經****去世 / 死亡****。

62. death vs dead

****death****

= noun: event/state of dying

****死亡****

****dead****

= adjective: no longer alive

****已死的****

Compare:

> his ****death****

> 他的死亡

> a ****dead**** animal

> 一隻死去的動物

63. dying vs dead

****dying****

= approaching death

****垂死的****

****dead****

= life has already ended

****已死亡的****

Compare:

> a ****dying**** tree

> 一棵正在枯死的樹

> a ****dead**** tree

> 一棵已枯死的樹

64. deadly vs deathly

Very important.

****deadly****

= able to cause death / extremely dangerous

****致命的****

> a deadly poison

> 致命毒物

****deathly****

= resembling death in appearance, stillness, color, silence, etc.

****死一般的；惨白的；死寂的****

> deathly pale

> 惨白的

65. die vs pass away

****die****

= neutral direct verb

****死亡；死****

****pass away****

= gentler/euphemistic expression

****去世；離世****

Compare:

> He died in 2020.

> 他在 2020 年去世。

> Her grandfather passed away peacefully.

> 她祖父安詳離世。

66. dead vs extinct

****dead****

= individual organism is no longer alive

****死的****

****extinct****

= entire species/type no longer exists

****滅絕的****

Compare:

> a dead animal
> 一隻死去的動物

> an extinct species
> 一個已滅絕的物種

67. dying vs declining

****dying****
= disappearing or nearing complete end
****瀕臨消亡的****

****declining****
= becoming weaker or smaller, but not necessarily close to disappearing
****衰退中的****

A ****dying industry**** is stronger than a merely ****declining industry****.

Meaning map

The central biological concept is:

****life ends****

From this develop:

Verb

die
→ ****死亡****

Noun

death
→ ****死亡****

Adjective

dead
→ ****已死的****

Process

dying

→ **垂死的**

Then figurative branches develop naturally:

Tradition

die out

→ **失傳 / 消亡**

Sound

die away

→ **逐漸消失**

Intensity

die down

→ **逐漸平息**

Device

phone dies

→ **沒電 / 停止運作**

Activity

dead town

→ **死氣沉沉 / 冷清**

Exactness/intensity

dead right

→ **完全正確**

Industry

dying industry

→ **日漸衰退的產業**

Danger

deadly

→ **致命的**

Appearance

deathly pale

→ **慘白的**

Abstract ending

death of an industry

→ **產業的消亡**

The passage uses the literal core:

> **between life and death**

> → **介乎生與死之間**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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die — biological	停止生命；死亡 / 去世
die of/from	因疾病、傷害、原因等而死亡
die — disappear/end	傳統、習俗等逐漸消失 / 消亡
die out	完全消失、失傳或滅絕
die away	聲音、光線等逐漸減弱直到消失
die down	風勢、情緒、爭議等逐漸減弱 / 平息
die off	多個生命體相繼死亡 / 大量死亡
die — machine/device	設備停止運作；電池耗盡
be dying to do	非常想做某事；迫不及待
be dying for	非常想要 / 極需要某物
death — literal	生命永久終結；死亡
a death	一宗 / 一次死亡事件
death — figurative ending	制度、傳統、產業等的終結 / 消亡
Death — personified	擬人化的死亡 / 死神
cause of death	導致某人死亡的原因；死因
death toll	某事件造成的死亡人數
death penalty	死刑
death sentence — literal	死刑判決
death sentence — figurative	對某人 / 某事造成毀滅性後果的致命打擊
death row	關押死刑犯的死囚區
dead — literal	已不再有生命的；死的
dead — device/system	已停止運作 / 沒電 / 失效的
dead battery	已無電量的電池
dead — inactive	沒有活動、非常冷清或死氣沉沉的

dead silence	完全沒有聲音；一片死寂	
dead — intensifier	完全地、徹底地	
dead right/wrong	完全正確 / 完全錯誤	
dead centre/ahead	正中央 / 正前方	
dead — numb	身體部位麻木、失去知覺的	
dead line/connection	已失效、沒有訊號的線路 / 連線	
dead language	已無母語使用者的死語	
dead technology	已淘汰、停止使用的技術	
dead inside	情緒麻木、空虛；心如死灰	
dying — literal	接近死亡的；垂死的	
dying — disappearing	正逐漸消失、瀕臨消亡的	
dying industry	日漸式微、接近消失的產業	
deathbed	臨終病床；臨終時期	
deadly — lethal	能造成死亡的；致命的	
deadly — very dangerous	極度危險的	
deadly — highly effective	極具殺傷力、非常準確有效的	
deathly	像死亡般慘白、安靜、冰冷等的	
deaden	使感覺、疼痛、聲音等減弱 / 麻木	
deadlock	雙方無法取得進展的僵局	
deadline	必須完成某事的最遲時間；截止日期	
dead end — literal	沒有出口的死路 / 死巷	
dead end — figurative	沒有進展或出路的死胡同	
life and death	生與死；亦可指極其重要、攸關生死	
matter of life and death	生死攸關 / 極其重要的事情	
scare someone to death	把某人嚇得要命；嚇壞某人	
bore someone to death	使某人無聊透頂	
work someone to death	令某人過度勞累；操勞至極	
sick to death of	對某事厭煩透頂 / 受夠了	
at death's door	病危；命在旦夕	
to the death	戰至死亡；拼到底	
drop dead — literal	突然倒地死亡	
drop dead — insult	很粗魯地叫人滾開 / 去死	
dead and buried — figurative	某事已徹底結束 / 成為過去	

Passage recap

> “...a mysterious library between life and ****death****...”

Here:

****death**** = ****the permanent end of a living being's life****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **死亡**

* **死**

* contextually: **生與死之間**

Natural contextual translation:

她發現自己進入了一間處於生與死之間的神秘圖書館。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

death

= **the state or event in which life permanently ends**

死亡；生命終結

The essential family distinction is:

> **die**

> → 動詞：死亡

> **death**

> → 名詞：死亡

> **dead**

> → 形容詞：已死亡的

> **dying**

> → 形容詞：正在走向死亡的 / 垂死的

And two easily confused extensions are:

> **deadly**

> → **會致命的**

> **deathly**

> → **像死亡一般的，例如慘白、死寂**

So:

> a **deadly** disease

> → 致命疾病

but:

> **deathly** pale

> → 臉色慘白.